MELBOURNE DATA ANALYTICS PLATFORM · LDACA · SYDNEY INFORMATICS HUB

Point-and-click text analytics: an introduction to LDaCA Wordflow

A hands-on afternoon: shape your data, look through the lenses, find topics, and code text with GenAI

Dr Chao Sun · Sydney Informatics Hub, The University of Sydney

Monday 26 October 2026 · 2:00-5:00 pm · Meeting Room M03, Mezzanine, Melbourne Connect

LDaCA | The University of Sydney — Sydney Informatics Hub

Hosted by the **Melbourne Data Analytics Platform**, The University of Melbourne

WHILE WE GET STARTED

1. Open Wordflow

It offers an **update** when it starts: accept it. No prompt? **Help → Check for Updates**.

Not installed? `sih.tools/wordflow` : the desktop app for Mac or Windows, or **Launch in Binder** in your browser.

2. Open the workshop page

sih.tools/ldaca

Every step, the workshop key for Part 4, and catch-up files if you fall behind.

Wi-Fi: **eduroam**. Stuck at any point? Put your hand up: a helper will come to you.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT OF COUNTRY

We acknowledge the Wurundjeri Woi-wurrung people of the Kulin Nation, the Traditional Owners of the land on which we meet today, and pay our respects to their Elders past and present.

HOW THIS AFTERNOON WORKS

Show

A few minutes on screen: what a tool is for, and its first move.

Try it

That move on your laptop, a few steps from the sheet, the same for everyone.

Your time

Finish the steps with a helper beside you. Done early? The sheet has a few ideas to try.

- **More than two hours of this afternoon are yours** at the keyboard. Everything we don't show is in the August recordings.
- **Fallen behind?** Each part has a **checkpoint**: a Project file you import to catch up in under a minute.
- **Ask any time.** "Can it do X?" and ideas from your own research are the best part of the room.

WHO BUILT WORDFLOW?



Dr Chao Sun
Project tech lead
Sydney Informatics Hub



Dr Alex Guo
Principal developer
Sydney Informatics Hub



Prof. Monika Bednarek
Academic lead
Sydney Corpus Lab

All at the **University of Sydney**, a **partner institution** of the **Language Data Commons of Australia (LDaCA)** (DOI: 10.3565/kq2v-9g52), a **co-investment partnership with the Australian Research Data Commons (ARDC)** through the HASS and Indigenous Research Data Commons. The ARDC is enabled by the Australian Government's **National Collaborative Research Infrastructure Strategy (NCRIS)**. Today hosted by the **Melbourne Data Analytics Platform**.

Hosted by **MDAP**
Melbourne Data Analytics Platform

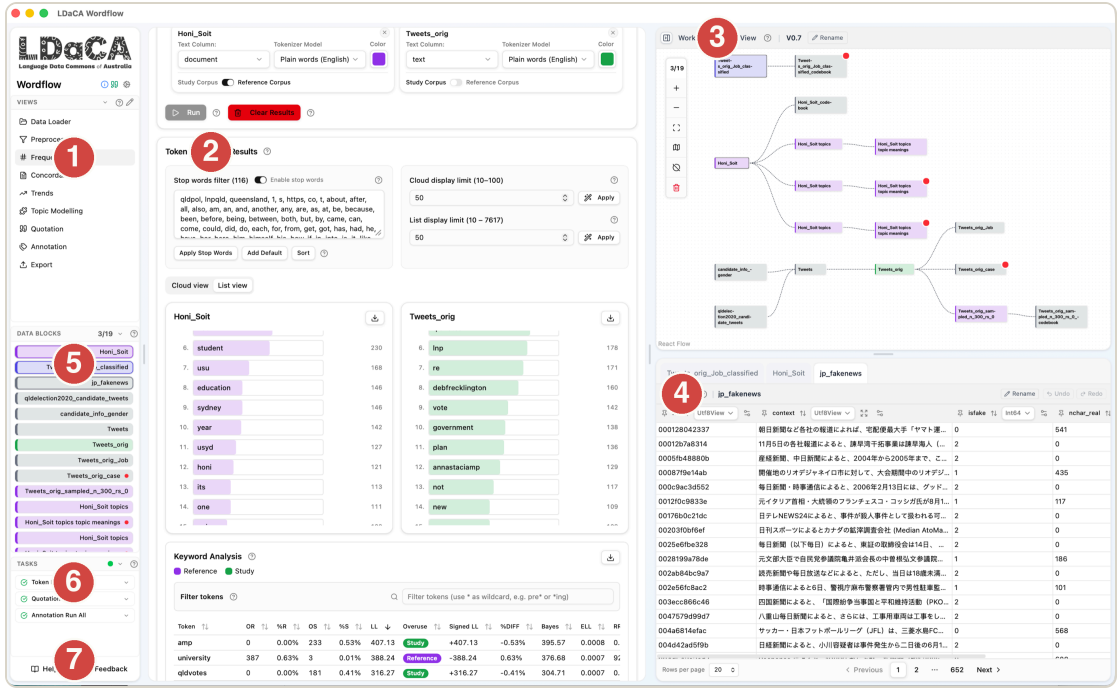
WHY WORDFLOW?

Modern text analysis (corpus methods, NLP, and now GenAI) mostly lives in **Python and R**. Learning and maintaining that is real effort on top of a busy research schedule.

Wordflow puts those methods behind **point-and-click tools**: your data stays visible, and every step can be inspected and retraced.

> Text data flows through stackable, single-purpose tools: the meaning of an analysis comes from how you shape your data, not from the tool itself.

THE INTERFACE AT A GLANCE



1. **Tool sidebar**: pick a tool
2. **Tool interface**: the selected tool's controls and results, in tabs
3. **Project Graph**: your data and every block derived from it
4. **Data Editor**: a block's rows and columns, with tools to clean and add columns
5. **Data Blocks**: switch the active block quickly
6. **Tasks**: progress of longer-running analyses
7. **Help & Feedback**: built-in documentation; a direct line to the team

ONE IDEA TO HOLD ONTO

The data block is what flows between the tools.

- Your imported dataset is a data block. A filter, a join, an analysis result: each becomes a **new block**, ready for any tool to read.
- Every tool is a **lens**. Click **Add to Project** and its results feed the next tool.
- The graph *is* your method: every step visible, every derivation traceable.

TODAY'S DATA

Try it: Queensland election tweets

2,380 tweets by candidates in the 2020 Queensland state election, with a table of **133 candidates**, their party and gender. Small enough that every step is quick on any laptop.

Bruns, A., Angus, D., Cohen, T., & QUT Digital Observatory (2022). *Queensland Election 2020 on Twitter*. QUT. doi.org/10.25912/RDF_1665115527020 · Australian Digital Observatory (ADO)

To explore: Australian Hansard

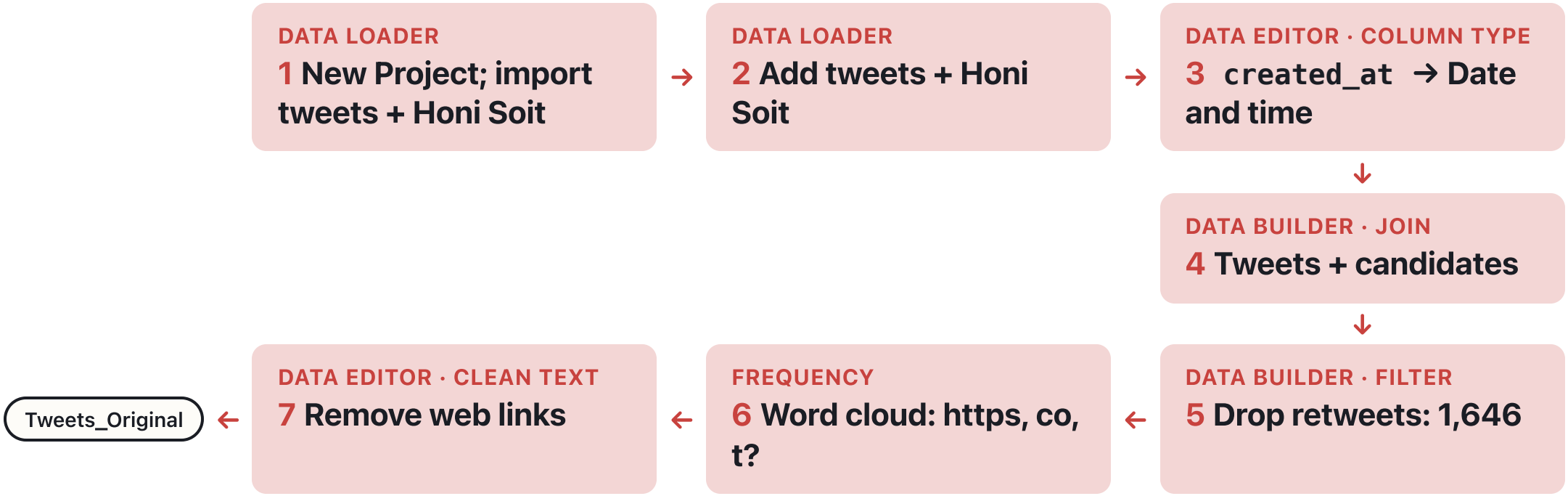
Every paragraph of the Federal Parliament's proceedings that mentions the **GST** (40,860), or is about **housing** (76,312), 1998 to 2026, with a speaker table to join for party and gender.

Hames, S., & Alpert, E. (2026). *Proceedings of Australian Federal Parliament: An Analytical Database* (Version 2026-09-21). Zenodo. doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22868754 · RAPID-CDL

THIS AFTERNOON

Time	Part	You'll leave able to
2:12	**1 Shape your data**	import, check and clean data; join and filter it into new blocks
2:47	**2 Look through the lenses**	see which words, read them in context, count them over time and across groups
3:25	Break	
3:35	**3 Topics**	find topics, read their most typical texts, name them, colour them by party
4:00	**4 Coding text with GenAI**	code text yourself, then check how well an AI model agrees with you
4:25	**Open lab**	Hansard, your own data, or the ideas on your sheet, with us beside you

PART 1 · SHAPE YOUR DATA



Most of these steps are in the August recordings, linked from **sih.tools/wordflow**. A few tools are new or have moved: the **Data Builder** (was Preprocessing) makes new blocks, and the new **Data Editor** changes a block's columns in place, with a preview and Undo.

PART 2 · LOOK THROUGH THE LENSES

Tweets_Original →

FREQUENCY
1 Which words?

→ click a word

CONCORDANCE
2 Click a word: read it

Tweets_Original →

TRENDS
3 Per day, by gender

Tweets_Original →

DATA EDITOR
4 `party` → Category, drag to order

→

TRENDS
5 Per party, stacked bars

TOPIC MODELLING PREP FOR PART 3 · START BOTH BEFORE THE BREAK

Tweets_Original →

TOPIC MODELLING · FIRST TAB
6 Tweets: start a run

Honi Soit →

TOPIC MODELLING · NEW TAB (+)
7 Max tokens 128, start a run

Break

Back at **in 10 minutes**. Your Topic Modelling run keeps going in the background: watch it in **Tasks**.

PART 3 · TOPICS

Tweets run →

TOPIC MODELLING
1 Hover the map →

SHOW EXAMPLES
2 Read a topic's texts →

RENAME
3 Name the topic →

DISPLAY OPTIONS
4 Colour by party

Honi Soit run →

SHOW EXAMPLES · OPEN DOCUMENT
5 One article, several topics

New since August: example texts, topic names and **Colour by**. Topic Modelling groups texts by meaning, not shared words.

PART 4 · CODING TEXT WITH GENAI

An AI model is just another coder.

It earns trust the way a human coder does: a **codebook**, a **pilot**, **agreement** scores, and **revision**.

Choosing a provider is a **research decision**: ethics approval, data privacy, local or commercial model, and cost.
Today: a workshop key for a small, inexpensive model, deleted at 5 pm. Your own key works too.

PART 4 · TRY IT

DATA LOADER

1 Import MDAP-Part4

→

ANNOTATION · TAB A-1

2 Read `Codebook_Job` and its Task context

→

ANNOTATION · MANUAL

3 Code page 1 by hand

↓

ANNOTATION · COMPARE TO

4 Compare to the checked labels

←

ANNOTATION · AI · ADD PROVIDER

5 OpenRouter + workshop key

←

ANNOTATION · PREVIEW

6 Pick the model; Preview, compare

OPEN LAB: YOUR DATA, OR HANSARD

Over time

- **Trends**: how often "GST" or "negative gearing" comes up, year by year
- Split by chamber, or by party after joining the speaker table

Who says what

- **Frequency**: compare two parties, or House and Senate

Close reading

- **Concordance**: every "first home buyers" or "housing affordability", in context

Themes

- **Topic Modelling** on a sample: what the housing debates are about, and how that shifts

Your own data

- A spreadsheet, a folder of texts, a ZIP: the **Data Loader** takes them all

Coding

- **Annotation** on your own categories: code a page by hand first

Reshape the data,

and the same tool tells a new story.

> Every tool is a lens. The interesting question is which lens, on which slice, for what purpose, and that's by your design.

KEEP GOING

Get Wordflow

sih.tools/wordflow: downloads for Mac and Windows, the browser option, and the documentation.

In the app: **Help** for the built-in docs, **Feedback** to tell us what you think.

Every step we didn't show, on video

Wordflow from zero, every tool step by step (90 min): youtu.be/ExYVSgvYIes

Coding text with GenAI, the Annotation tool (90 min): youtu.be/KcjJViYRYX4

Recorded in August on an earlier version: Workspace is now **Project**, Preprocessing is now the **Data Builder**, and the Data View is now the **Data Editor**.

Today's materials

sih.tools/ldaca: today's steps and checkpoints, there for a few weeks; then on the workshop landing page.

Hansard data: doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22868754 (RAPID-CDL)

Cite Wordflow & get in touch

Cite: doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20408328 (always the latest release)

Questions, or want Wordflow for your team? chao.sun@sydney.edu.au